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Last week: DJIA 43828.06 ▼ 814.46 1.82% NASDAQ 19926.72 ▲ 0.3% STOXX600 516.45 ▼ 0.8% 10-YR. TREASURY (Reopening) yield 4.398% OIL \$71.29 ▲ \$4.09 EURO \$1.0503 YEN 153.70

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Apple is preparing** major design and format changes to its lineup of iPhones and potentially other products, a bid to revive growth after years of offering largely incremental upgrades. **A1**
- ◆ **The Fed's Powell** is attempting to manage expectations on interest-rate cuts as investors heartened by past easings look for a third-in-a-row reduction this week. **A1**
- ◆ **Cable news loyalists** have grown a lot less loyal, at least to MSNBC and CNN, in the wake of Donald Trump's election win last month. **B1**
- ◆ **New economic data** from China suggest government efforts to boost the economy are struggling, a sign that Beijing will need to do more next year to rev up growth. **A7**
- ◆ **Brand-management** firm WHP is nearing a deal to purchase the iconic wedding-dress brand Vera Wang, people familiar with the matter said. **B3**
- ◆ **Boston-based** regional bank companies Berkshire Hills and Brookline are in talks to combine, according to people familiar with the matter. **B3**
- ◆ **Costco posted higher** sales in its latest quarter, during which it saw a split customer base willing to pay the highest and lowest prices. **B3**
- ◆ **Affirm said it entered** into an agreement to sell up to \$4 billion of its loans to private-credit firm Sixth Street over three years. **B4**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump's tariff threats** have triggered a behind-the-scenes lobbying campaign to soften or change the president-elect's plans, but the effort faces a potentially insurmountable roadblock in the leader's intransigence. **A1**
- ◆ **The collapse of the** Assad regime in Syria has unleashed a global hunt for the billions of dollars in cash and assets the family stashed away over half a century of despotic rule. **A1**
- ◆ **Some Trump allies** worry that a shift in his rhetoric could herald a watered down effort to remove undocumented migrants and are urging him not to change course. **A3**
- ◆ **Employers who rely** on the labor of undocumented migrants are uneasy about Trump's pledge to cut programs that provide them with temporary work permits. **A3**
- ◆ **Progressive Rep.** Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez is vying for the top spot on the Oversight and Accountability Committee, aided by like-minded House Democrats. **A4**
- ◆ **The federal government** is taking action to address a surge in drone flights over New Jersey and other East Coast locales, DHS Secretary Alejandro Mayorkas said. **A3**
- ◆ **ABC News agreed to a** \$15 million settlement of a defamation lawsuit brought by Trump against the network and anchor George Stephanopoulos. **A6**

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Ukraine Scouts Mark Bethlehem Flame's Arrival



SERGEY DOZHENKO/BAU SHUTTERSTOCK

RAY OF LIGHT: Members of Plast, the Ukraine scout organization, marked the Peace Light of Bethlehem's arrival in Kyiv on Sunday. The flame each year originates in the grotto of Jesus' birth and is carried through several countries before Christmas.

Trump Resists Push by CEOs To Soften His Tariff Stance

BY BRIAN SCHWARTZ

Donald Trump's tariff threats have triggered a behind-the-scenes lobbying campaign to soften or alter the president-elect's plans. But the effort faces a potentially insurmountable roadblock: Trump isn't budging.

That has left business executives scratching their heads about how to lobby for exemptions from the steep tariffs Trump has promised on imports from China, Canada, Mexico and other countries.

So far, executives are facing setbacks as they canvass Trump's aides for advice on how to influence the president-elect's next steps. Trump is largely acting on his own, leaving his incoming team of advisers with few opportunities to shape his thinking. His recent late-night social-media statements about tariffs have come with little warning even to some of his closest allies, according to people familiar with the matter.

Trump's team has told corporate consultants there is no

waving the president-elect off his plans to make liberal use of tariffs once he gets into office, the people said.

With Inauguration Day less than two months away, companies based in the U.S. and around the world are weighing the possibility that Trump will follow through on many of his campaign-trail warnings, potentially triggering a multifront trade war that economists warn could increase prices for consumers. Across-the-board tariffs would have major implications for businesses, poten-

tially raising costs for U.S.-based companies that import products from abroad.

Late last month, Trump said in a Truth Social post that he would place a 25% tariff on imports from Canada and Mexico if the countries didn't do more to stem the flow of migrants and drugs across the border. He raised the prospect of im-

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◆ **The love-hate relationship with corporate power..... A5**
◆ **Manufacturers stock up amid tariff fears.....B5**

Apple Sees Foldable iPhone As a Key To Growth

BY AARON TILLEY AND YANG JIE

Apple is preparing a series of major design and format changes to its lineup of iPhones and potentially other products, a bid to revive growth after years of offering largely incremental upgrades.

Starting next year, Apple plans to introduce an iPhone that will be thinner than the approximately 8-millimeter profile of current models, said people familiar with the company's plans. The model is intended to be cheaper than Pro models, with a simplified camera system to reduce costs.

The company is also planning two foldable devices, the people said. A larger device, intended to serve as a laptop, would have a screen that unfolds to be nearly as large as some desktop monitors, at about 19 inches. A smaller model would unfold to a display size that would be larger than an iPhone 16 Pro Max, intended to serve as a foldable iPhone, the people said.

Both foldable designs have been in development for years, but some key parts weren't ready. Major challenges included improving the

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INSIDE



JASON GAY
Vermont's thrilling run to the men's soccer national championship game. **A14**

BUSINESS & FINANCE
Bitcoin's recent rally has tested some high-profile onetime skeptics. **B1**

Mariah Carey Reignites A Burning Household Debate

Singer opposes overhead lights, mobilizing forces against an 'attack on the senses'

BY JOSEPH DE AVILA

A power struggle over lighting flares up whenever Sue and Jerry Dawson entertain in their Hernando, Fla., home.

Sue prefers keeping the house well lighted with overhead lights during get-togethers, believing it helps conversation flow and allows guests to admire the appetizer spread. Jerry has a dimmer

view.

"I turn them on, and he turns them off or down," said Sue, 72 years old, who has been married to Jerry for nearly 50 years. "Otherwise it's like a cave in here. Maybe he is part troglodyte, I don't know."

Jerry likened himself to Roderick Usher, the light-sensitive lead character in Edgar Allan Poe's "The Fall of the

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The Drugs Young Bankers Use to Get Through the Day

BY ALEXANDER SAEEDY

As Mark Moran was facing another 90-hour week as an investment-banking intern at Credit Suisse in New York, he knew he needed help to survive the rest of the summer. His colleagues gave him a tip: Visit a Wall Street health clinic and tell the staff he had trouble focusing.

Ahead of his first appointment, he filled out a five-minute questionnaire. One of the questions asked if he had trouble staying organized, another, if he procrastinated. He then met with a clinician who said his answers suggested he had attention-deficit hyperactivity disorder. He left with a prescrip-

tion for Adderall.

No matter that a family member, a psychologist, didn't think Moran had ADHD. He found that when he took Adderall, he could keep working for hours, and was able to actually be interested in some of the mundane tasks required of a young investment banker, such as aligning corporate logos on a PowerPoint or formatting cells in Microsoft Excel.

He also wanted to show his bosses he was a hard worker and eventually secure a lucrative full-time job offer after finishing graduate school.

"They gave me a script, and within

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Missing Assad Billions Spark a Global Search

BY BENOIT FAUCON AND RORY JONES

With the collapse of the Assad regime in Syria, a global hunt is now beginning for the billions of dollars in cash and assets the family stashed away over half a century of despotic rule.

The chase will likely be long. The Assad family has built a broad network of investments and business interests over the decades since the patriarch, Hafez al-Assad, seized power in 1970. Among the international

purchases made over the years by close kin of his son, the deposed leader Bashar al-Assad, are prime real estate in Russia, Viennese boutique hotels and a private jet located in Dubai, according to former U.S. officials, lawyers and research organizations that have investigated the former ruling clan's fortunes.

Human-rights lawyers say they are planning to track more assets, hoping to recover them

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◆ **Assad's fall cuts off Hezbollah supply lines... A9**

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